

Example of Character Creation

Meg's gaming group — her friends Amy, Dan, Ricky and their Storyteller, Pete — is getting ready to start a new **Changeling** chronicle. After tussling with schedules, everyone gathers one night to sit down over dinner to discuss the types of stories they want to tell, hash out setting details, and make characters. Pete tells them he has some ideas for a basic setup he'd like to use as a backdrop, and with nothing else in mind the group agrees that sounds good to them. They just have one request — they just got out of a **Vampire** game and don't want any high-level politics. Pete says that's fine with him, and he tells them that the game is going to take place in modern-day Philadelphia, in a blue collar neighborhood that's now also the home of a thriving new art scene. He wants to focus on the tension between the area's rough and tumble roots and the new bohemian element that's mixing in, and asks the group to use that as a starting point.

Meg and the other players take a few minutes to think on the basic setting. As they're pondering, Amy speaks up, saying she'd like the group to be centered on a small bar, a place that used to be a local dive but has now become a gathering place for the new artist community in the area. That should go nicely with Pete's theme of the tension between the blue collar and bohemian elements of the neighborhood, and he goes one further to suggest that the place could actually be a brand new freehold, one struggling to establish itself as a faerie sanctuary just as it's also making a name for itself in the local artistic community.

The group likes the idea of building up a freehold as they tell their stories, and settle on the name Kraftwerk for the bar. If they want to make it an official freehold, they'll have to purchase the relevant Backgrounds during character creation, so they make a note to put points in it individually as they go on. Now they have a setting around which to center their concepts, but Meg is still a little uncertain about what she wants to play, so she decides to wait and help the others with their characters, then see what comes up as they're brainstorming.

Concept

Amy asks if the rest of the group would be okay with her playing a sidhe as the owner of the bar and the leader of the freehold. She describes her potential character, Harper, a local girl who grew up in the neighborhood and who is also an Autumn sidhe of House Liam. The group agrees that a blue collar character who's now deeply invested in the arts seems perfect. In addition, Harper has little interest in local politics and, as a member of House Liam, isn't likely to be invited to a lot of high society meetings anyway, so the group's wish to avoid heavy politics stays intact. Harper is approved.

Using Amy's idea as a base, Ricky asks if he can play one of her employees, a satyr barback named Colin. Relatively new to his faerie nature, Colin was drawn to the freehold as a way of settling into his identity, and now uses his Birthright to help get the crowd going when there are live bands or special events on site. Ricky also thinks that Colin will have local

